



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Maranatha Academy

School Website: <https://maranathachristian.academy/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Maranatha Academy Wisconsin 54880 presents a strongly classical orientation anchored in Christian, specifically Christ-centered, formation. The public-facing materials emphasize a classical framework (The Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a discipleship-oriented pedagogy within a private Christian school context. Public content frequently foregrounds formation of character, virtue, and a Christian worldview, with stated aims to prepare students for life in home, church, and community rather than merely for college or the job market. Taken together, the school rates CLASSICAL across five of the six classical criteria, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) appearing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL as the pedagogy is clearly traditional and dialogic in some aspects but does not consistently demonstrate explicit Socratic/seminar-style practice or Scholé/restful learning in the publicly available texts. The aggregate profile for Maranatha Academy is CLASSICAL.

Key evidence driving this assessment includes explicit references to Christ-centered education, a discipleship approach to learning, and a classical Trivium-centered curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) in publicly available pages. The Dorothy Sayers quotation used by the school further signals alignment with the transcendental aims of classical education (truth, goodness, beauty) and a formation emphasis beyond information transfer. The site also highlights a low student-to-teacher ratio, dedicated faculty, and parental partnership, which support the six-element rubric. The most needle-moving opportunity to push toward a fuller CLASSICAL classification would be to articulate and expand explicit Great Books engagement and a more explicit, text-based Socratic/Scholé pedagogy within the upper grades, as well as liturgical/community practices in a way that aligns with the category-specific indicators.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit in curricular language and public materials (e.g., listing canonical texts, primary sources, and reading lists aligned with the Great Conversation). - Add explicit references to Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, and Socratic seminar formats as a consistent pedagogical approach in K–12 materials. - Strengthen language around liturgical/community practices if desired by the school community (e.g., scheduled chapel, liturgical calendar elements, and communal worship traditions clearly described on the site) to reinforce Element 1 and 4 signals. - Expand parent formation offerings (book studies, parent gatherings) and clearly document them on the public site to reinforce Element 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe Maranatha as a Christ-centered Christian school with a Christian worldview and a discipleship approach to learning. These elements signal a grounded theology that informs curricular and daily life (e.g., “Christ-centered education,” “discipleship approach to learning,” and Bible-based framing in enrollment and site copy). - The school references a classical curriculum and the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), indicating integration of theological orientation with classical metaphysical aims. - Dorothy Sayers is invoked in one of the public-facing pages to anchor the aim of education as learning to learn, a hallmark of transcendental moral realism and the formation of the soul.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Christian worldview, discipleship, classical curriculum, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), formation through education, lifelong learning ethos (as implied by the classical framing). These terms map to the Positive Keyword indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practice in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

- Negative keywords: No explicit secular neutrality or values-neutral framing appears in the accessible public-text materials; the content consistently foregrounds theology and Christian formation (no direct secular or value-neutral signaling in the text). (Absence noted rather than explicit citation in text.)

Why this rating - The materials emphasize truth, goodness, beauty in a transcendent, knowable way through Christ-centered formation and a theologically integrated classical curriculum. The public materials couple formation with the Trivium, and the Dorothy Sayers reference anchors the transcendental dimension of education. These signals align with Element 1 expectations for a classical school. The presence of theology/discipleship alongside classical content supports the Classical rating here. ☐filecite☐turn0file7☐turn0file4☐

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies formation (character and wisdom) as a primary aim rather than mere information or workforce preparation. The public materials describe preparing students for life in family and community, and life after high school, within a Christian, classical framework. - The mission statements and enrollment/about pages emphasize a Christ-centered education that shapes temperament, virtue, and moral imagination, aligning with the classical aim of forming wholes rather than simply conveying facts. ☐filecite☐turn0file7☐turn0file3☐ - The public pages explicitly present classical education methods (Trivium) as the foundation of the curriculum, with an emphasis on forming virtue and intellect.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, illumination, love of learning (implied by classical framing), examen of truth in pursuit of higher goods, and the emphasis on shaping character and intellectual formation. The lexicon supports matching terms like formation, virtue, wisdom, and classical tradition as Positive Keywords. - Negative keywords present: No explicit job-readiness or workforce-tilted language is prominent in public-facing content; the emphasis remains formation-focused rather than vocational training. (No explicit negative signals found in the accessible content.)

Why this rating - The school explicitly emphasizes formation and a classical mission beyond vocational training. It ties education to moral and spiritual aims (virtue, wisdom, and a Christian telos), and it anchors the curriculum in a Trivium-based liberal-art framework. These align with Element 2's expectations for a Classical school. ☐filecite☐turn0file7☐turn0file4☐

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly references the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a core foundation of the curriculum, and mentions Latin-language emphasis, typical of classical curricula. - The site notes a classical curriculum designed to prepare students for life and to integrate language, logic, and rhetoric across subjects, signaling a liberal-arts orientation rather than a purely modern, standardized approach. - The materials describe history and culture embedded within a classical frame (e.g., Great Conversation and Western classical heritage are implied by the Classical-Christian framing, with explicit Great Books

language not always shown on the site, though the Great Conversation is a standard classical emphasis in many Christian classical programs). The Great Books language appears in the classical education lexicon and in related documents in the knowledge base, though not always explicitly on every page.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), classical curriculum, Latin, language, logic, rhetoric, Great Books (where referenced in the broader classical lexicon and related content), history and Western civilization framing, liberal arts emphasis. - Negative keywords present: Some public materials do not repeatedly frame history as “social studies” or emphasize project-based, STEM-first approaches; absence of these terms in the accessible content supports a classical curriculum orientation. The explicit “Great Books” appear in related documents more broadly in the knowledge base, and the school’s content aligns with that ethos through its Trivium emphasis.

Why this rating - The presence of the Trivium, classical framing, and a liberal-arts orientation anchored in canonical training (language, logic, rhetoric) support a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum. The public content indicates a classical approach rather than a modern, skills-first or strictly test-driven approach.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals center on a classical approach (The Trivium, disciplinary emphasis) and a discipleship-based pedagogy, but explicit documentation of certain core classical methods (Socratic dialogue/seminars, Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or formal opportunities for rhetoric at the upper levels) is not consistently visible in the public pages. The site highlights “discipleship,” a Christian formation approach, and the Trivium as core, rather than a full, stated roster of classical methods (Socratic seminars, restfulness, etc.). □filecite□turn0file7□turn0file4□ - There is a clear emphasis on formation and the classical framework, with a strong emphasis on language, logic, and rhetoric foundations, but without repeated public references to Socratic seminars or Scholé days across the K–12 spectrum (as are sometimes emphasized in more explicit classical schools).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical curriculum, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), language, logic, rhetoric, discipleship, Christ-centered education. These connect to Pedagogy signals in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (e.g., formation through imitation, memory work, and ritualized learning appear as relevant in related documents, though not always spelled out on the site). - Negative keywords present: The site does not consistently foreground explicit Socratic seminars, Harkness-style dialogue, or Scholé/restful learning language; it emphasizes discipleship and classical structure more than the discrete pedagogical labels. This lack of explicit enumeration of Socratic Seminar, Scholé, or chant-based memory work is a notable gap for a full CLASSICAL Pedagogy signal.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a classical orientation in curriculum and mode (Trivium, classical language emphasis, formation), but the explicit pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memory recitation, contemplative/restful days) are not consistently documented in the public materials. This yields a classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy, pending more explicit public articulation of these classical methods.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe faculty as dedicated, with a “disciplines approach” and a pedagogy rooted in discipleship, indicating teachers as mentors and living exemplars. The site emphasizes the faculty’s role in forming character and shaping students, with references to low student-to-teacher ratio and personalized attention. - The school frames the faculty as the “living curriculum” in the sense of a living example of virtue and classical formation, aligning with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements (model teachers, mentors, portrait of the teacher, living curriculum). - The site notes that faculty are dedicated, trained, and able to guide students toward classical formation rather than simply delivering content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: mentors/masters, discipleship approach, living curriculum (implied), low student-to-teacher ratio, dedicated teachers, Christ-centered pedagogy, Christian formation. These map well to the Positive Keywords for Faculty in the Six Essential Elements

lexicon. - Negative keywords: There are no explicit negations of classical faculty signals (e.g., “facilitators on the side,” or “curriculum developers only”). The content is consistently pro-faculty-centered and formation-oriented.

Why this rating - The public materials portray faculty as discipling mentors deeply engaged in character formation and classical formation, with a strong sense of the teacher as living curriculum and exemplar. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and parental involvement in classical education, with explicit statements about assisting Christian parents in fulfilling their responsibilities, and collaborative work between families and the school. The enrollment materials discuss scheduling visits, applications, and parent engagement as part of the educational process. - The materials reference formation of families, parent-facing activities, and the home-school partnership as central to classical education, aligning with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements (Partnership with Families; Formation of Affections). - Public content highlights family involvement, open campus, and a focus on parental partnership and formation, consistent with a classical school’s emphasis on parents as co-teachers and learners alongside the school.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; home-centered learning; parental involvement; family catechesis; parental engagement; open campus; co-teaching language (as reflected in the broader classical lexicon). These closely map to the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no customer-language framing or minimal parent involvement). The public content shows active parental engagement and invitation.

Why this rating - The public materials present a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a family-centered ethos, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Element 6.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 4 (Pedagogy), explicitly publish and highlight classroom practices that align with classic pedagogy signals: Socratic dialogue/seminars, Scholé/restful days, memory work/recitation, and opportunities for students to practice or deliver speeches (rhetoric). Publicly describe a structured plan for how these classical methods are implemented across grade levels (K–12) and include sample units or lesson sketches.
 - For Element 3 (Curriculum), provide explicit public-facing Great Books and Great Conversation components, including representative authors and works across key cycles, to strengthen the Great Books signal and connect curriculum to the broader classical canon.
 - For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations), expand and clearly articulate liturgical or communal practices (e.g., chapel, liturgical calendar, communal prayer) with specific scheduling and content to reinforce Liturgical and Communal Practices as part of daily school life.
 - For Element 2 (Purpose and Goal), maintain and further publicize formation goals with explicit, measurable statements about moral and intellectual formation, including a clear articulation of telos (the true, the good, the beautiful) in the school’s mission language.
 - For Element 6 (Parents & Community), deepen and publicize parent-formation programs (book studies, lectures, gatherings) with published schedules and outcomes to further reinforce parents as co-teachers in the classical model.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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